all officers attending without exception and the duty officers attending daily as a precaution against any false sermonizing. As a result of this, we did not have a single case of desertion or insubordination during this period. We all had to walk a fine line in an explosive situation.

When Indira Gandhi was assassinated, we were put on high alert, lest Pakistan take some advantage of this dastardly event. The Forward Zone was occupied in strength. The Company at Sangam was beefed up as were the Platoon posts on either side all along the LC/IB. In addition to Sangam, where an officer always stayed, one post on either side was also manned by an officer. I was manning a post to the North and 2/Lt Narendra Parmar, who had joined in June that year, was to the South of Sangam. One evening, about a month into our deployment, Narendra rang me up at about 2110 hours or so, to say that he was observing some unusual movement across the LC and had already counted about ten to fifteen lights coming towards the LC. I immediately shimmied up the tree that had a machan that served as my observation post. I too could see the lights of a single pair of headlights coming towards us from about two to three km away, approaching to about two km away and then disappearing from sight, to be followed by another set of headlights a little later. By the time I digested the situation, the sightings had crossed forty in number. Was this the enemy sneaking up on us one vehicle at a time? But then, with headlights on? This was way beyond our pay grade. I rang up the Company Commander and the telephone lines buzzed right up the chain to the Division HQ, who put the entire Division on 'Stand To', all posts to be manned in full strength round the clock. The numbers kept increasing from fifty to sixty to seventy, even as the Divisional Commander spoke individually to all of us. By the time the sightings stopped in the wee hours

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